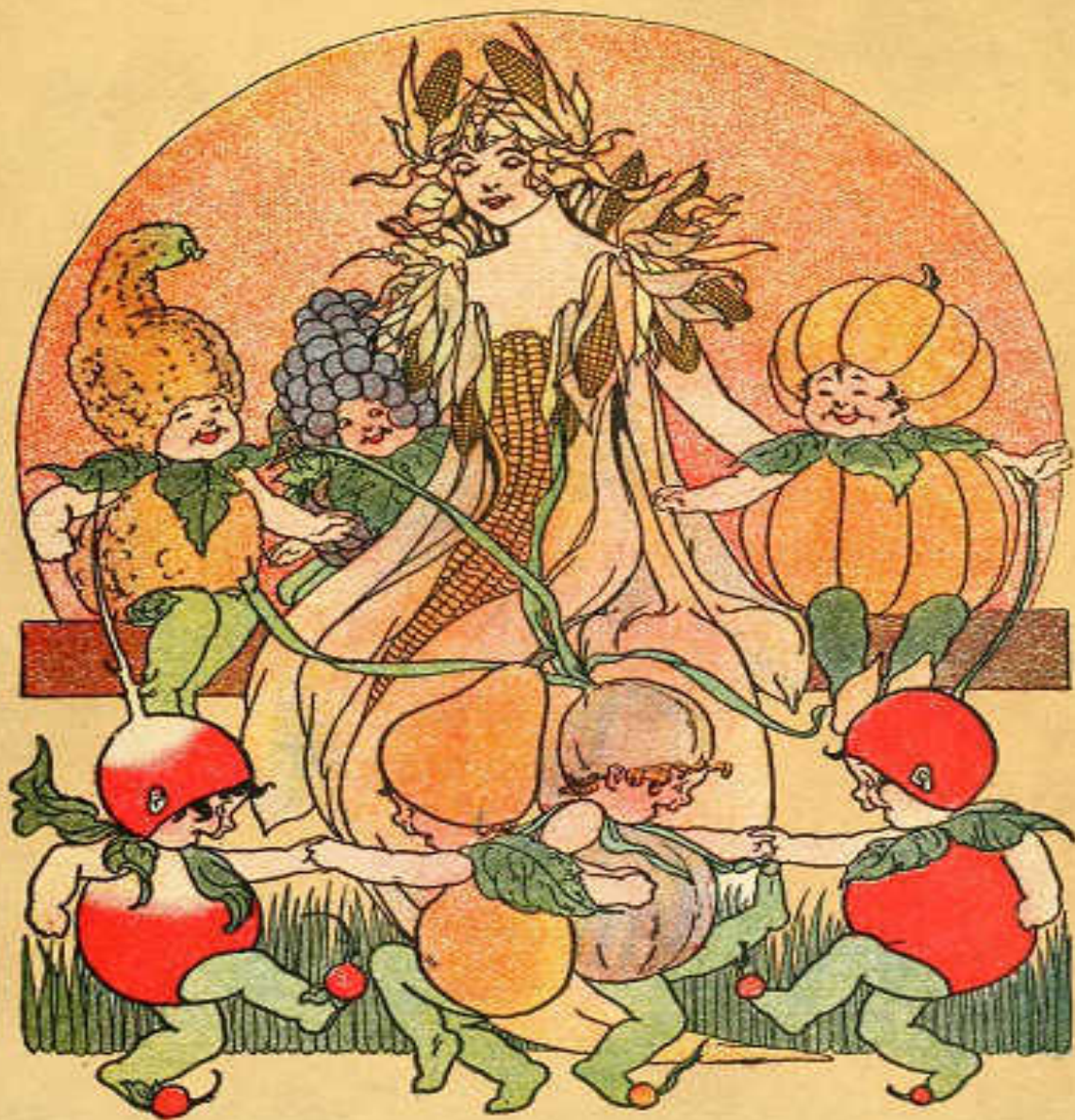


# MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN

*THE FROLICS OF THE  
FRUITS AND VEGETABLES*



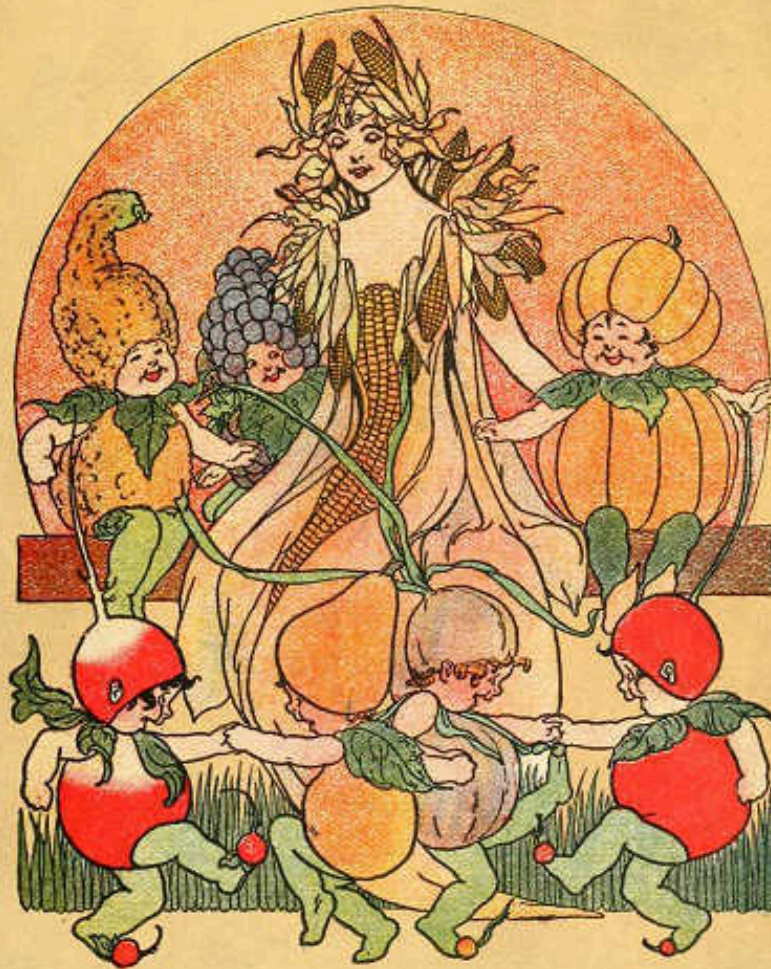
ELIZABETH GORDON

ILLUSTRATIONS  
M.T. ROSS



# MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN

*THE FROLICS OF THE  
FRUITS AND VEGETABLES*



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EARTH'S CHILDREN: THE FROLICS OF THE FRUITS AND  
VEGETABLES \*\*\*

Mother Earth's Children

## The Frolics of the Fruits and Vegetables



# Mother Earth's Children

The Frolics of the  
Fruits and Vegetables



BY  
**Elizabeth Gordon**  
Author of  
Flower Children, Bird Children,  
etc.

With illustrations by  
**M.T. Ross**



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**Second Edition**

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*This little book is a thank-offering to the thousands of little friends who have so loyally given me their best in the way of encouragement and appreciation, and is most especially inscribed to Gladys Doris.*

---

## FOREWORD



seed, little friends, is really a plant or a tree all wrapped up in a little brown bundle. If you plant it in the ground it will grow, and when it is old enough it will bear fruit, because God has made it so.

¶ Among all the children of Mother Nature, the fruits and vegetables are probably the most useful to us. Wherever we may go some of these little people are there before us, ready to help us by giving us food and to make life easy and joyous for us.

¶ In your Mother's garden you will always find many familiar friends; in the fields the graceful Grain children will nod and beckon to you; in the orchard the Fruit children will peep out at you from their leafy homes; along the roadside the gay little Berries will give you a friendly greeting, and in the forest you will find the little wild Grapes climbing trees and playing hide and seek with the Bird children.

¶ The publishers, who have already given you the Flower Children, Bird Children, and Animal Children, wish to join the author and the artist in their grateful acknowledgment of the wonderful appreciation which these books have received, and to hope that these new comrades will prove as fascinating as those whom you already know.

¶ For myself, little friends, I thank you from my heart.

ELIZABETH GORDON.

---







## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**L**ITTLE Miss Radish, pretty thing,  
Has her birthday in the spring;  
She and the little Onions play  
Out in the garden all the day.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**W**HEN Orchard Oriole sings his song  
The Rhubarb children troop along;  
They're hardy, healthy youngsters, too,  
And stay the whole, long summer through.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Lettuce, tender-hearted lass:  
“Come Dandelion, ’neath my glass;”  
But Dandelion smiled and said  
She liked the nice fresh air instead.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S** AID Spanish Onion: "I don't see  
Why people weep at sight of me;  
I'm a nice, friendly sort of chappie  
And like to make everybody happy."





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Button Mushrooms went to play  
With the small Puff Balls one bright day;  
They had such heaps of glorious fun,  
But all ran home at set of sun.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**A**SPARAGUS in early spring  
Came up to hear the robins sing;  
When she peeped out her dress was white;  
It turned green in the sunshine bright.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Green Pea children went to sail  
On the Sauce Pan ocean in a gale;  
“This boat’s a shell,” they cried; “Dear me!  
We might capsize in this deep sea.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S** AID Spinach: "In my dress of green  
I'm just as happy as a queen.  
I'm truly glad that I am good  
For little babies' early food."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**L**ITTLE Wild Strawberry came down  
To visit with her folks in town;  
She's a sweet child with charming ways  
And blushes modestly at praise.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Endive: "I was born in France  
But travel when I get a chance."  
Said Celery: "I travel, too,  
But my real home's in Kalamazoo."





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Carrot ladies love to go  
To church on Sundays in a row;  
And, tall or short, each lady fair  
Wears a green feather in her hair,



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**P**EARL Onion, tiny little thing,  
Lives out doors from early spring;  
She's German, so I understand,  
And dearly loves her father-land.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE dainty little Water Cresses,  
In their pretty bathing dresses,  
Like water fairies splash and play  
In the cool brooklet all the day.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



“CHERRIES are ripe,” said Old Blue Jay  
As he flew by one August day;  
“Why, he means us,” the Cherries  
cried,  
“Perhaps we’d better go inside.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**W**HEN Gooseberry wears a gown of green  
She cries and pouts and makes a scene;  
But when her gown's a purplish hue  
She never disagrees with you.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE String Beans love to climb a pole,  
And so their clothes are seldom whole.  
Mother Bean said: "I'll mend the tatters;  
While they are happy, nothing matters!"





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Dame Potato: "Hurry, Pat!  
And wash your face and feed the cat,  
Then run to school, or you'll be late;  
Just see! It's nearly half past eight!"



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



“GOOD morning, friends! Know who I am?  
I’m Raspberry who makes the jam;  
You know—that on the pantry shelf—  
I make that every year myself.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**W**HITE Turnip said: "I'm pale, I know  
And all our family are so."  
"I should advise," said old White  
Beet,  
"A course of sugar cakes to eat."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**R**ED Pepper said a biting word  
Which Miss Green Pepper overheard;  
Said she: "Hot words you can't recall;  
Better not say such things at all."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S** AID Miss Cucumber: "I have brought  
My fan, because the day is hot;  
Our family have a splendid rule,—  
Whatever happens, we keep cool."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**M**ISS Parsley raised her plummy head,  
And in her modest manner said:  
“I’m only asked to dine, I know,  
Because my dress becomes me so!”





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**G**UMBO'S a splendid southern cook,  
And, without looking in the book,  
He'll make a savory soup or stew,  
And send it, steaming hot, to you.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Blueberry children love to run  
Around the hillsides in the sun;  
Smiling and jolly, plump and sweet,  
Best-natured youngsters one could meet.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



“**E**VERY one knows,” said Madame Beet  
“My disposition’s very sweet;  
And though to plumpness I am prone,  
My color’s every bit my own.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



“MY new spring dress,” said Chicory,  
“Is just as lacy as can be;  
Shading from green to purest  
white  
Its ruffles are my heart’s delight!”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**F**IG is the queerest chap; you know  
The way that fellow starts to grow?  
Just a small bud upon the bough,  
No flower at all—that's clever now!



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE pretty little ladies Rice  
You'll always turn to look at twice;  
They came from India long ago,  
And now they're everywhere you go.





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Currant ladies look so sweet  
In their green dresses, cool and neat.  
They offer you, for your delight,  
Their strings of berries, red and white.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Brussels Sprout: "I am so glad  
That I'm such a good-looking lad."  
Horseradish said: "I'm glad I'm plain  
If good looks make a chap so vain."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Rutabaga Turnip: "Wow!  
I just escaped that hungry cow;  
I jumped behind a great big tree  
Or she'd have surely eaten me!"



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Blackberry children love to run  
And play beneath the August sun  
Until each little maid and man  
Takes on a friendly coat of tan.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**C**ARRAGEEN makes his bow to you.  
He's a sea child, that is true,  
But he's so jolly—never cross—  
His other name is Irish Moss.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



“THE person they named after me,”  
Said Oyster Plant, “lives in the  
sea;  
I’m very sure I could not sleep  
‘Rocked in the cradle of the deep.’”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**Y**OUNG California Artichoke  
Exclaimed: "It is the richest joke  
That many people, young and old,  
How to eat me must be told!"





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



“**D**EAR me!” Madam Muskmelon said,  
“Those children will not stay in  
bed;  
Before the darlings get misplaced  
I’ll tie each baby to my waist.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**W**ATERMELON'S dress of green  
Trimmed in rose pink you all have  
seen  
She has such pleasant smiling ways,  
We welcome her on summer days.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**O**LIVE'S a sweet Italian maid,  
Her gown is green—a lovely shade.  
Though just at first she's rather shy,  
You get to like her by and by.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Mustard Children grew so tall  
They looked right over the garden-wall;  
They're rather sharp and forward, so  
That's why they're left outside, you know.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Cauliflower: "I used to be  
A cabbage, so some folks tell me;  
When I've improved some more—who knows?  
Maybe I'll be a Cabbage Rose."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**H**AND in hand with summer comes  
The happy family called the Plums,  
Some dressed in purple, some in red;  
They're very pretty and well bred.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



S AID Garlic: “My home used to be  
In far-off, sunny Sicily;  
But people here think I’m a blessing,  
I make such splendid salad dressing.”





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**Y**AM really is a pretty fellow,  
Though his complexion's rather yellow;  
When Winter comes he packs his grip  
And goes north for a little trip.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID pompous, purple Egg-plant: “Well!  
So that is egg in that queer shell;  
Really! It’s very hard to see  
Why they named that chap after me!”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**V**EGETABLE Marrow liked to tell  
How he was once an English swell;  
Summer Squash laughed and said: "My word!  
That's quite the best thing Hi 'ave 'eard."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Hubbard Squash: "All summer long  
I'm on the farm where I belong,  
But in the fall, for change of air,  
I go to see the County Fair."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID busy, bustling Mrs. Quince:  
“I never have a moment since  
The jelly-making time is here;  
We’re making such a lot this year.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Mother Pear: “Dear me! Those twins  
Are just as much alike as pins;  
I must do something, I declare!”  
So she cut little sister’s hair.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**B**ANANA wears a yellow coat  
Buttoned quite snugly 'round his throat.  
He comes from where it's warm, you see,  
And feels cold more than you or me.





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**H**ERE'S an odd child named Cashew—  
Provides you nuts and apples, too;  
Oil and wine, and other things  
This busy young Brazilian brings.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



A FOREIGN lady of renown—  
Pomegranate in her crimson gown,  
Smiling and nodding as she goes,  
Looks like an Oriental rose.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**L**ITTLE Miss Sugar Cane is sweet—  
In truth, she's good enough to eat.  
She gives us sugar, nice and white,  
And syrup to make things taste right.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**H**ERR Burgomaster Cabbage said:  
“My little dog, he needs some bread.”  
Frau Cabbage smiled; “Just help yourself,  
A fresh loaf’s on the pantry shelf.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**H**ERE'S Apple, loved by young and old  
And sometimes worth his weight in gold.  
We hail him with delighted cries  
When he comes to us, baked in pies.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**P**INEAPPLE has so many “eyes”  
You cannot take him by surprise;  
He’s full of sunshine, through and through,  
And always has a treat for you.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



C OFFEE said: "I must really study  
To find why my complexion's muddy.  
Perhaps it's only tan, you know  
I do run out bareheaded so!"





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**M**R. Green Tea comes from Japan,  
He's such a wrinkled little man;  
He says: "My tea is very nice,  
Will you have sugar, milk or ice?"



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**B**ARLEY'S a bearded gentleman,  
He wears a suit of golden tan;  
Though he has homes both east and west  
He loves the prairie lands the best.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



“**I**DINNA care,” said bluff Scotch Oat,  
“For dinner at a table d’hote;  
A bowl of porridge and some tea,  
At home, are good enough for me.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**“I**’LL be grown up,” said Caraway,  
“And out of school Thanksgiving Day;  
That’s a good thing, too, ’cause you see,  
They can’t make cookies without me.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



“OUR family’s not hard to suit,”  
Said Mrs. Peach. “We’re simple fruit;  
We like most any kind of weather  
If the sun shines, and we’re together.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**H**ICKORY Nut looks rough and rude,  
Although at heart he's very good.  
If once you get inside his shell  
You're sure to like him very well.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Cactus: "On the desert wild  
I used to be a naughty child,  
But since I went to Burbank's school,  
I'm good, and live by Golden Rule."





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



“THE boys all call me ‘Nigger Toe,’”  
Brazil Nut said; “I think I’ll go  
Back to Brazil; ’t would serve them  
right  
And teach them to be more polite.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



C OCOANUT has a funny face,  
Eyes, nose and mouth all in one place;  
He's always busy selling milk,  
While Mrs. Coccoanut makes silk.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Mrs. Peanut, in a flutter,  
“I quite forgot to salt the butter;”  
The little Peanut children said:  
“Why then, Mama, we’ll salt the bread.”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Chestnut: "I work for my living  
I stuff the turkey on Thanksgiving.  
On winter days I work down town;  
You'll know me by my coat of brown."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**P**ERSIMMON said: "I'm up so high  
I can reach out and touch the sky."  
Bre'r Possum said: "Don't reach too far,  
You might put out a shining star."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



S AID Mr. Gourd: "You'll plainly see  
We are a busy family;  
We give you bottles, cups and things,  
And curly vines for playtime rings."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**L**ITTLE, wise, home-loving Truffle  
Never lets his temper ruffle;  
His home is just beneath the ground,  
And there he always may be found.





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**W**ILD Grape just loves to run away  
And in the green woods climb and  
play;  
You'll know him when among the trees  
His fragrant blossoms scent the breeze.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HOUGH Miss Grape Fruit is very young  
Her praises are on every tongue;  
And though she travels everywhere  
She has a very modest air.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Lemons every summer go  
In groups to see the Wild West Show;  
Come rain or shine, they never stay  
At home on any circus day.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**M**ISS Cotton is a fairy queen  
In her white dress all trimmed with  
green;  
To other children everywhere  
She sends such pretty clothes to wear.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**M**ISS Orange said: "I'd like to know  
Those pretty mountain girls called  
'Snow;'"

"Don't," said her Dad, "or we are lost;  
They're relatives of Sir Jack Frost."



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**M**ISS Beechnut wears a pretty bonnet  
With little fuzzy feathers on it.  
She's very sweet, and always good;  
Her home is in the deep, wild wood



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



“**I**WORK,” said genial Mrs. Wheat,  
“To give the world enough to eat;  
I’m always happy when there’s bread  
Enough, so every child is fed.”





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**C**ITRON is very plump and round,  
He likes to roll upon the ground;  
Come rain or shine he's always happy,  
A nice, contented little chappie.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



C RANBERRY dearly loves to go  
Wading in places wet and low;  
She wears soft gowns of dainty floss  
Made of the pretty yellow moss.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**AID Indian Corn: "I'm heap rich brave,  
Much shiny gold I make and save."  
So Squaw Corn went and bought a bonnet,  
And a silk gown with tassels on it.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**N**ORTH Wind came whistling by one day  
Where the Tomatoes were at play;  
It gave those children such a fright  
They put their blankets on that night.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



THE oddest child—when all is said—  
Of those we've met, is St. John's Bread;  
He's Spanish, so I've understood,  
And makes a food that's very good.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Nutmeg children ran away  
To tease the cook on baking day.  
Said Mother Nutmeg, in surprise:  
“Why! Who will spice the custard pies?”



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Pumpkin children, everyone,  
On Hallowe'en go out for fun;  
With Jack o'lantern and his crew  
They find such jolly things to do.





## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**W**HEN Jack Frost said: “Now, children all,  
Go in before the snowflakes fall,”  
Parsnip declared he liked the snow  
To cover him, and didn’t go.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**S**IR English Walnut, pompous, fat,  
Is quite a great aristocrat.  
His family is very old;  
They lived in Bible times, we're told.



## MOTHER EARTH'S CHILDREN



**T**HE Popcorn children are so dear  
They stay with us all through the year;  
They like to dance in dresses white  
Around the open fire at night.

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| Gooseberry     | <a href="#"><u>23</u></a> | Summer Squash    | <a href="#"><u>53</u></a> |
| Gourd          | <a href="#"><u>77</u></a> | Tomato           | <a href="#"><u>89</u></a> |
| Grape Fruit    | <a href="#"><u>80</u></a> | Truffle          | <a href="#"><u>78</u></a> |
| Green Onion    | <a href="#"><u>9</u></a>  | Vegetable Marrow | <a href="#"><u>53</u></a> |
| Green Pea      | <a href="#"><u>15</u></a> | Water Cress      | <a href="#"><u>21</u></a> |
| Green Pepper   | <a href="#"><u>28</u></a> | Watermelon       | <a href="#"><u>45</u></a> |
| Green Tea      | <a href="#"><u>65</u></a> | Wheat            | <a href="#"><u>85</u></a> |
| Gumbo          | <a href="#"><u>31</u></a> | White Turnip     | <a href="#"><u>27</u></a> |
| Hickory Nut    | <a href="#"><u>70</u></a> | Wild Grape       | <a href="#"><u>79</u></a> |
| Horseradish    | <a href="#"><u>38</u></a> | Wild Strawberry  | <a href="#"><u>17</u></a> |
| Hubbard Squash | <a href="#"><u>54</u></a> | Yam              | <a href="#"><u>51</u></a> |
| Indian Corn    | <a href="#"><u>88</u></a> |                  |                           |

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